

Study: Social Media and Identity Theft

Introduction: Social media platforms like Facebook, Twitter, and Instagram have become integral parts of our daily lives, offering convenient ways to stay connected. However, the ease of sharing personal information on these platforms also makes users vulnerable to identity theft.

Scenario: Over-sharing on social media can leave individuals susceptible to identity theft, as fraudsters exploit the abundance of personal information available online. This case study examines real-life examples of social media-related fraud, including impersonation, scams, and phishing attacks.

Discussion Questions and Answers:

1. Why does over-sharing on social media increase the risk of identity theft?

Answer:

- **Exposure of Personal Information:** When individuals share excessive personal information on social media platforms
- **Social Engineering Attacks:** Over-sharing can make individuals more vulnerable to social engineering attacks.
- **Location Tracking:** Many social media platforms allow users to share their current location or tag their location in posts and photos.
- **Sharing Sensitive Documents:** Some individuals might unknowingly share sensitive documents or images on social media platforms,
- **Friend Requests and Connections:** Accepting friend requests or connections from unfamiliar or suspicious accounts can expose individuals to identity theft risks.

2-How do impersonation and fake accounts on social media contribute to identity theft?

Answer:

Gathering Personal Information: Impersonators and creators of fake accounts often engage in social engineering tactics to extract personal

information from unsuspecting individuals.

- Phishing Attacks: Impersonators and fake accounts are commonly used to initiate phishing attacks on social media platforms.
- Reputation Damage: Impersonation on social media can harm an individual's reputation and lead to identity theft indirectly

3-What are some examples of social media scams designed to steal financial information?

Answer:

- Phishing Scams: Phishing scams are prevalent on social media platforms. Scammers create fake accounts or impersonate legitimate organizations or individuals to trick users into providing their financial information.
- Fake Customer Support: Scammers may create fake customer support accounts on social media platforms, posing as representatives of wellknown companies or service providers.
- Investment Scams: Social media platforms are commonly used for investment scams, promising high returns or exclusive investment opportunities.

4-How can individuals defend against social media fraud and identity theft?

Answer:

- Strengthen Passwords: Use strong and unique passwords for each social media account. Include a combination of upper and lowercase letters, numbers, and special characters. Avoid using easily guessable information like your name or date of birth.
- Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA): Activate two-factor

authentication whenever possible. This adds an extra layer of security by requiring a second verification step,

- Be Cautious with Friend Requests and Links: Only accept friend requests from individuals you know or can verify.